

Dashboard Navigator & Reference Manual

Superstore Sales & Profitability Interactive Analytics Guide

1. KPI Summary Banner & Global Controls

Located across the top of the dashboard, the primary KPI cards and slicers provide high-level health metrics and real-time interactive filtering across all visuals:

- **Total Sales (\$2.30M) & Units Sold (38K):** Measures gross revenue generation and total item fulfillment volume.
- **Total Profit (\$286.40K) & Profit Margin (12.5%):** Displays net corporate earnings and overall bottom-line efficiency.
- **Global Filters (Month, Region, Category):** Use the dropdowns or regional selection tiles to filter the entire view. Selecting **West** or **Technology** instantly recalculates all KPIs and charts on the page to reflect data exclusively for that selection.

2. Monthly Trend & Discount Impact (Top-Left Visual)

Visual Type: Line and Clustered Column Chart

- **Blue Bars (Total Sales):** Tracks gross monthly revenue (\$0K to \$300K+).
- **Solid Green Line (Profit Margin %):** Displays net profit margin percentage for each month.
- **Dashed Orange Line (Avg Discount %):** Tracks the average promotional discount rate applied.
- **Core Insight:** Demonstrates a direct inverse relationship between discounting and profitability. When the orange discount line rises, the green profit margin line drops sharply toward 8.5%.

3. Regional Performance Comparison (Top-Right Visual)

Visual Type: Clustered Column Chart

- **Blue Bar:** Gross sales volume across operating territories.
- **Green Bar & Data Label:** Net profit dollar amount generated.
- **Core Insight:** **West** leads profitability (\$108K profit, ~15% margin), followed by **East** (\$92K, ~14%). While **Central** generates substantial sales (\$500K+), its profit margin is severely depressed (~8% margin / \$40K profit) due to aggressive localized discounting.

4. Sub-Category Profit Leakage (Bottom-Left Visual)

Visual Type: Clustered Bar Chart

- **Green Bars (Right):** Sub-categories driving positive net profit.
- **Red Bars (Left):** Sub-categories operating at a cumulative net loss ("the leaks").
- **Core Insight:** **Copiers** (\$56K), **Phones** (\$45K), and **Accessories** (\$42K) generate the vast majority of net earnings. Conversely, **Tables (-\$18K)**, **Bookcases (-\$3K)**, and **Supplies (-\$1K)** act as major profit drains eroding total returns.

5. Discount Sensitivity Matrix (Bottom-Right Visual)

Visual Type: Scatter Chart

- **X-Axis (Avg Discount):** Promotional discount level (5% to 40%).
- **Y-Axis (Profit Margin):** Net profit margin percentage (-10% to 40%+).
- **Bubble Size / Color:** Bubble size represents revenue volume; colors distinguish product categories (Blue = Furniture, Purple = Office Supplies, Grey = Technology).
- **Red Dashed Line:** The 0% break-even threshold line.
- **Core Insight:** Product bubbles falling below the red line (e.g., Tables, Bookcases) reflect severe margin destruction when discounts exceed 20%. Items like **Binders** sustain higher discounts (~35%) while maintaining positive margins due to higher underlying markup.